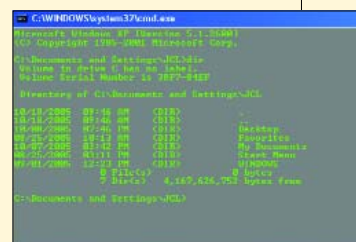


THIS MONTH'S CHALLENGE

Change the AutoComplete key and colour of the Windows XP command prompt



How would you change the colour of the Windows Command Prompt—both the text and background colour—as well as the key assigned for AutoComplete, from [Tab] to [Ctrl] + [F] (without using third-party utilities)? Write in with the subject 'Take a crack', and your postal address, to takeacrack@thinkdigit.com with your solution

LAST MONTH'S CHALLENGE

Win!



Take a Crack and Win Professional DCOM Application

By Jonathan Pinnock
Published by Shroff Publishers & Distributors Pvt Ltd

LAST MONTH'S WINNER

KP Peter

Mech (AR) 3, NIAT,
Naval Base, Kochi
Kerala

Rules and Regulations

Readers are requested to send in their answers by the 15th of the month of publication.

Employees of Jasubhai Digital Media and their relatives are not permitted to participate in this contest.

Readers are encouraged to send their replies by e-mail. Jasubhai Digital Media will not entertain any unsolicited communication.

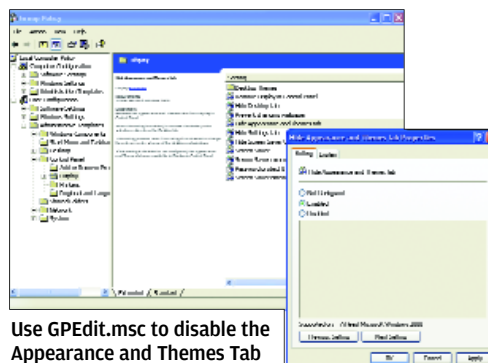
Jasubhai Digital Media is not responsible for any damage to your system that may be caused while you are trying to solve the problem.

Hide the Themes, Screensaver, Appearance and Settings as well as prevent changing the Desktop wallpaper

You can hide the themes, screensaver, appearance and settings in the 'Display Properties' window, by two methods—using the Group Policy Editor or via the Registry.

The first method is by using the Group Policy Editor. To start it, go to **Start > Run**, type in "gpedit.msc" and press OK.

Go to the User Configuration tab and then to 'Administrative Templates'. Then go to 'Control Panel', and there, select 'Display'.



Use GPEdit.msc to disable the Appearance and Themes Tab

Double-click 'Hide Appearance and Themes tab', then click the 'Enable' radio button. Click 'Apply', then 'OK'. Your 'Appearance and Themes' tab will disappear from the display properties.

In the same way, you can select 'Hide Screen Saver tab', and 'Hide Settings tab' to hide the screensaver and the settings from the display properties. Similarly, you can also prevent changing of the wallpaper.

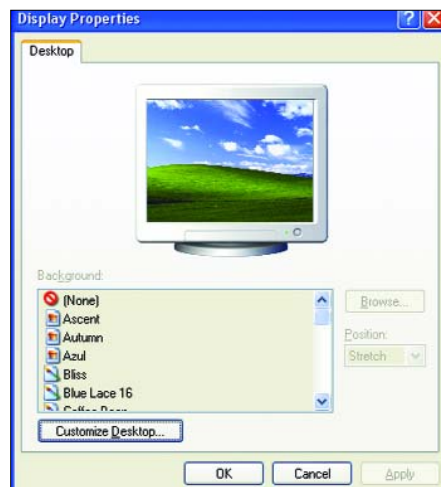
The second method is by using only the Registry Editor. To prevent changing of the wallpaper, navigate to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\ActiveDesktop** (if the key isn't there already, create it.)

Once there, create a DWORD called "NoChangingWallpaper". Set the DWORD value to "1". ("1" is for disabling it, and "0" is for enabling it.)

To remove the screensaver, go to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System**. Create a DWORD called "NoDispScrSavPage" and set the DWORD value to "1".

To remove the Appearance and Theme tabs, go to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System**. There, create a DWORD called "NoDispAppearancePage" and set the DWORD value to "1".

To remove the Settings tab, go to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System**. Now create a DWORD called "NoDispSettingsPage" and set the DWORD value to "1".



Display properties with only the Desktop tab

If the System key we've mentioned isn't there, you'll need to create it under 'Policies' by right-clicking on 'Policies', then selecting **New > Key**. Rename it to "System". Similarly, **NoDispScrSavPage**, **NoDispAppearancePage** and **NoDispSettingsPage** can be created by clicking **New > DWORD Value** after right-clicking 'System'. ☑